Lesson 8 — The Line We Share

Part 6 of 12: Comprehension — a full TOEFL set of ten

Level: B1 (eighth step)

About 45 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

Part A — Multiple choice

> This is a full set of ten, the size of a real TOEFL reading set.

1. (Factual) How many families share the line?

   A. Two.
   B. Four.
   C. Seven.
   D. Thirty.

2. (Factual) When does Aya download the slides?

   A. On Monday at eight.
   B. On Sunday night.
   C. During the class.
   D. Whenever the teacher sends them.

3. (Negative factual) According to the passage, all of the following happen when the line is only slow EXCEPT

   A. the video stops.
   B. the voice survives.
   C. the class carries on.
   D. the lesson ends for everybody.

4. (Vocabulary in context) The word "stutter" in the passage is closest in meaning to

   A. keep stopping and starting.
   B. become louder.
   C. disconnect completely.
   D. cost more.

5. (Reference) In the sentence, there is simply nothing to pass on, the words "nothing to pass on" refer to

   A. no antenna.
   B. no neighbours.
   C. no signal.

D. no electricity.

6. (Inference) It can be inferred from the passage that Aya

A. expects the exchange application to fail.

B. treats the connection as a condition to work around rather than a reason to stop.

C. would rather study alone than in an online class.

D. plans to move to a street with a better line.

7. (Sentence insertion) Look at the four letters [A] [B] [C] [D] in the passage. Where would this sentence best fit?

> Planning for the bad evening costs very little on a good one.

- A. At [A]
- B. At [B]
- C. At [C]
- D. At [D]

8. (Purpose of a paragraph) Why does the writer describe what Aya would do with a faster line?

A. To show that she is not satisfied with her neighbours.

B. To explain how a mesh network is built.

C. To show that she separates what she cannot change from what she can.

D. To argue that fifty megabits should be available to everyone.

9. (Purpose of the whole passage) What is the writer's main purpose in the whole passage?

A. To explain the technology of mesh networks.

B. To describe the difficulty of applying to a university abroad.

C. To show how one student works, and plans, around a connection that seven families share.

D. To persuade neighbours to agree rules about large uploads.

10. (The writer's attitude) Which word best describes the writer's attitude towards Aya?

A. Pitying.

B. Doubtful.

C. Amused.

D. Respectful.

Part C — Fill in the blanks

Use these words. There are two extra words you will not need.

> uplink · mesh · latency · reliable · antenna · tower · scholarship · requirement · relay

1. Seven families share one _____.

2. In a _____, every point passes the signal on to the next.
3. The _____ on the roof is a length of pipe and two brackets.
4. She downloads the slides when the _____ is low.
5. The rules are what make a shared line _____.
6. The exchange place has a small _____ attached to it.
7. There is a language _____ she is four months from meeting.

Part D — Summary

Write the story in two sentences only. Use a first conditional once and a second conditional once.

> Sentence 1 — what will happen if the uplink fails on a Monday: _____ Sentence 2 — what Aya would do if she had a faster line: _____